

Using JQuery for Mobile App Development

JQuery is a touch-optimised Web framework. Instead of writing unique applications for each device, it allows for the development of a single application which will work universally across all devices. This article covers the basics of JQuery app development for mobiles, its features, events, methods, forms and page transitions.

JQuery Mobile is a touch-friendly Web UI development framework that is used to develop mobile Web applications that work across smartphones and tablets. The JQuery Mobile framework builds on top of the JQuery core and provides a number of features, including HTML and XML document object model (DOM) traversing and manipulation, event handling, performing server communication using Ajax, as well as animation and image effects for Web pages.

JQuery Mobile is a free, dual-licensed (MIT and GPL) library. The code is in draft form and its components are available in the alpha release. It promises to be a great framework and toolset for developing mobile Web applications.

Features of JQuery Mobile

1. **Overall simplicity:** This framework is easy to use, and you can develop many pages using markups driven by minimal or no JavaScript.
2. **Progressive enhancement and graceful degradation:** While JQuery Mobile leverages the latest versions of HTML5, CSS3 and JavaScript, not all mobile devices provide such support. JQuery Mobile's philosophy is to support both high-end and

less capable devices, such as those without JavaScript support, and still provide the best possible experience.

3. **Accessibility:** JQuery Mobile has support for accessible rich Internet applications (ARIA) to help create Web pages that are accessible to visitors with disabilities, using assistive technologies.
4. **Small size:** The overall size of the JQuery Mobile framework is relatively small at 12KB for the JavaScript library and 6KB for CSS.
5. **Theming:** It provides a theme based system that allows you to develop the styling of your application.

The structure of a JQuery Mobile page

The following aspects define the structure of a JQuery Mobile page:

1. **Header bar:** This part contains the page title and back button.
2. **Content:** This part contains the entire contents of the application or the body part of the application.
3. **Footer bar:** This footer bar contains the navigational part, copyright information of the application and whatever we wish to add.

